BOLD, HONEST AND EVERYWHERE

***HUMA QURESHI** has a jampacked release schedule with* Jolly LLB 3, Maharani *S4,* Delhi Crime *S3,* Bayaan, *her home production* Baby Do Die Do, *and the juggernaut* Toxic *led by* KGF *star Yash*



Q. In the mainstream with *Jolly LLB 3* and *Toxic*, headlining *Maharani* and *Delhi Crime*, star of Toronto Film Festival premiere *Bayaan*, and now actor-producer of *Baby Do Die Do*. What's the idea behind casting a wide net?
It's quite magical that such a large variety of work is coming to me. Bollywood tends to slot actors in certain templates. We used to be told actresses have a shelf life—that's an untrue, outdated model that's no longer working.

Q. What can you tell us about your upcoming projects?
Bayaan is a crime procedural, where writer-director Bikas Ranjan Mishra was mentored by *Chernobyl* creator Craig Mazin. *Baby Do Die Do* is a Mumbai-set hitwoman story. My brother Saqib Saleem is producing it. The stories go forward in *Maharani* and *Delhi Crime*. I can't say anything about *Toxic* yet.

Q. You have written a novel, *Zeba: The Accidental Superhero*. Plans to turn it into a film?
I am excited about using AI to turn *Zeba* into a film. I am considering writing a sequel also, but I'm not finding the time to give to *Zeba*. It was a COVID project, so I had the bandwidth then.

Q. As a woman who is now in charge of her own work and has found success across genres and formats, what is your advice to young women who want to be as successful as you?
Be yourself. Don't have a narrow idea of yourself based on what others tell you about your worth. It is your responsibility to yourself to tell the world to shut up. You need to be brutally honest to yourself.

—DEVARSI GHOSH